

Lesson outcome

Learners can ask and answer simple questions in a job interview.

- Lead-in 1** Look at the job advert. What skills, personal qualities and experience does the employer want?

Assistant Customer Services Manager

We need an enthusiastic and motivated Assistant Customer Services Manager with excellent communication skills. You will be responsible for a team of Customer Service Reps for a major bank. We work across multiple channels – email, live chat, telephone and social media. The ideal candidate will have at least two years' customer service experience.

- VIDEO 2** 8.4.1 Watch the beginning of the video. What is Angela's current job?



- 3A** Watch the video. Are the sentences *true (T)* or *false (F)*?

- Angela's first job was as a Personal Assistant (PA).
- She has a lot of experience of dealing with customers.
- She says speaking is the most important communication skill.
- Problem-solving skills are a part of her job every day.
- She deals with customers using social media.
- She says her job can sometimes be stressful when customers are bored.
- She wants to work for the bank because it has an excellent reputation for social media.
- She'd like to do more staff training in the future.

- B** Correct the wrong words in the sentences in Exercise 3A.

- 4A** Watch again. Complete the interview questions with the words in the box.

had helped leave questions see strengths tell want

- Can you _____ me about your work experience?
- What are your main _____?
- How have you _____ to motivate staff?
- Have you ever _____ any problems with difficult people in your teams?
- Why do you _____ to work for our company?
- Why do you want to _____ your current job?
- Where do you _____ yourself in five years?
- Do you have any _____ for me?

- B** Work in pairs. Match the answers (a–h) with the questions (1–8) in Exercise 4A. What other answers can you give to the questions?

- Your company has an excellent reputation for customer service.
- I'd like to develop my skills and do more staff training.
- I work as a team leader in customer services.
- I have excellent communication skills.
- I've always set goals with my staff and when they meet the goals, we celebrate.
- Yes, I do. What training opportunities are there with this job?
- I enjoy my work and I've learnt a lot but your organisation offers more opportunities.
- Yes, there have sometimes been problems between team members.

Speaking

> JOB INTERVIEWS

Talking about work experience

Can you tell me about your work experience?

I work as a /an [team leader / Manager / Assistant] in [customer services / Sales / Marketing].

I started as a /an [Shop Assistant / Junior Designer / Admin Assistant].

Then I moved into [customer services / Banking / Engineering].

I have a lot of experience dealing with [customers / suppliers / difficult staff].

Talking about skills and personal qualities

What are your main strengths?

How have you helped to motivate staff?

Have you ever organised training sessions?

Have you ever had problems with difficult people?

I'm good at [motivating a team / training staff / managing projects].

I have excellent/good [communication skills / IT skills / presentation skills].

I've always [set goals with staff / listened to staff / given staff targets].

I've done a lot of staff training and given presentations.

I've [learnt a lot / always worked hard / enjoyed challenges].

Talking about the company

Why do you want to work for our company?

Your [company / bank] has an excellent reputation for [customer service / career development].

Your organisation offers [more opportunities / career development / interesting challenges].

Do you have any questions for me?

What training opportunities are there with this job?

T Teacher's resources:
extra activities

**5 You are going to roleplay two job interviews.**

Student A: Look at page 124.

Student B: Look at page 126.

Read your information. Use the phrases in the box to help you and add any extra ideas you want.

Interviewer**Job candidate**

Ask about work experience.

Answer.

Ask about main strengths.

Answer.

Ask about helping to motivate staff.

Answer.

Ask why he/she wants to join the company.

Answer.

Ask why he/she wants to leave his/her current job.

Answer.

Ask him/her his/her thoughts on his/her future in five years.

Answer.

Invite the job candidate to ask questions.

Ask the interviewer some questions.

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Introduction

1 Complete the job advertisement with the headings in the box.

Your role and responsibilities About our company Your skills and experience

Operations Manager



a _____
We are a global transport and logistics company with over 64,000 employees at 1,200 locations in over 90 countries.

b _____
We have a great opportunity for an Operations Manager for the northern UK region. You will manage transport services for our customers. Our contracts include the delivery of food and drink to thousands of cafés, hotels and restaurants in the region.

- c** _____
- degree or equivalent
 - previous experience of managing transport operations essential
 - previous experience of dealing with clients
 - can use Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint
 - can manage and motivate a team of managers and staff
 - good problem-solving skills
 - can meet project deadlines

Speaking

2 Look at the words in the box. Which of these skills and personal qualities are essential for the job in Exercise 1? Which are useful? Why?

It's essential to have good IT skills. The Operations Manager will use software programs.

analytical communication skills hard-working IT skills
language skills motivated organised team worker

3 Match the halves of the interview questions.

- | | |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1 Can you tell me about | a current job? |
| 2 What are your | b in our company? |
| 3 Why do you want to work | c your work experience? |
| 4 Why do you want to leave your | d main strengths? |
| 5 Where do you see yourself | e in five years? |

4 Complete the interview questions with the Present Perfect Simple form of the words in brackets.

- _____ (you/ever/work) with clients in this industry?
- _____ (you/manage) a large team of staff?
- _____ (you/ever/deal with) difficult customers?
- _____ (you/use) Microsoft software?
- _____ (you/ever/work) on projects with deadlines?

Roleplay

5 You are candidates for the job in Exercise 1. Read and complete your information.

Student A: Look at page 120. Student B: Look at page 125.

Student C: Look at page 127. Student D: Look at page 123.

6 Take turns being the interviewer and the candidate. Use the questions from Exercises 3 and 4 in your interview.

Student A: Interview Student C. Student B: Interview Student D.

Student C: Interview Student B. Student D: Interview Student A.

7A Work in pairs. Tell each other about the candidate you interviewed.

B Compare the candidates. Who is the best candidate for the job? Why?

I think she is the best candidate. She's had more experience in the transport industry.